

ContactsFreeShare User Manual

Contacts, MeetingData, Field List, Address Book, GoogleConnect, and app update workflows

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Overview

ContactsFreeShare is a local desktop web app for maintaining a shared contact directory, creating MeetingData layouts, designing Field Lists, and producing printable Address Book PDFs. It runs in a browser at `http://127.0.0.1:8000`, but its data and files live on the computer running the app.

The app can work locally, or it can connect to Google for contacts, Google Drive backups, App Revisions, shared settings, and multi-editor workflows. When GoogleConnect is enabled, local changes can queue until the user chooses Upload.

Main Work Areas

- **Contacts:** Add, edit, filter, move, message, email, delete, import, export, and back up contact records.
- **MeetingData:** Create meeting sections and edit their printable visual layout.
- **Field List:** Build and print field list templates using contact fields, meetings, phones, addresses, relationships, emails, and page numbers.
- **Address Book:** Configure and generate an address book PDF, including cover, index, print order, field choices, and paper book output.
- **GoogleConnect:** Sign in, control editor roles, import, upload, sync, and monitor Google/Drive state.
- **App Revisions:** View revision notes, check for public app updates, and download update packages.

Global Navigation And Menus

The top navigation appears across the app. Some pages may also show page-specific actions below the top menu.

ContactsFreeShare Menu

Menu Item	What It Does
About	Opens the About modal with the app name, current version, year, and short description.
Address Book	Opens the Address Book PDF builder where book layout, cover, index, field choices, print order, and PDF output are controlled.
Field List	Opens the Field List builder for creating and printing field list templates.
Changes List	Opens the shared Changes List for recording contact and MeetingData change notes.
Settings	Opens ContactsFreeShare Settings for editor mode, single/multi-editor behavior, shared PDF folder, editor secret, lockout time, and colors.
Check for updates	Checks the public update manifest to see if a newer ContactsFreeShare package is available.
App Revisions	Shows recent app revision notes and the update status panel.
Quit AddbookFreeShare	Closes the browser view or shows a closed message. The local server process may still need to be stopped from its terminal window.

File Menu

Menu Item	What It Does
Import	Starts the Google import workflow. It can import contacts from Google Contacts or import from a Drive backup after confirmation.
Export > App CSV	Exports contacts in the app's CSV format to the computer.
Export > Google CSV	Exports contacts in a Google-compatible CSV format.
Export > vCard	Exports contacts as a vCard file.
Backup > Contacts to Computer	Downloads a local JSON backup of contacts.

Backup > Contacts to Google Drive	Saves a contacts JSON backup to the Google Drive Backups folder.
Backup > MeetingData to Computer	Downloads a local JSON backup of MeetingData.
Backup > MeetingData to Google Drive	Saves a MeetingData JSON backup to Google Drive.

Top-Level Links

Link	What It Does
Contacts	Opens the main contacts list.
MeetingData	Opens the MeetingData section list.
EditLists	Opens a submenu for Contacts Edit List and MeetingData Edit List.
GoogleConnect	Opens Google connection, editor sign-in, upload, and sync status controls.

Contacts Page

The Contacts page is the main directory. It shows contact names, fields, meetings, phones, and addresses. Click a row to open the contact detail page. Use checkboxes to select contacts for bulk actions.

Page Actions

Action	What It Does
New Contact	Opens the new contact editor.
Message	Opens a modal for sending separate text messages to selected contacts with usable Mobile or Cell numbers. On macOS, the app now prefers the paired phone/SMS service when available and falls back to iMessage only if SMS is unavailable.
Email	Opens a modal that builds a mailto email with selected contacts in BCC.
Delete	Moves selected contacts to the Deleted meeting/category after confirmation.
Move	Opens the Move Contacts page for changing selected contacts' Fields and Meetings.
Upload	Uploads pending local changes to Google Contacts and Drive when GoogleConnect is configured.

Filters And Selection Menu

Control	What It Does
Search box	Filters by family or given name.
All fields dropdown	Filters contacts by field. It also includes Add Field, Delete Field, and Rename Field commands.
All meetings dropdown	Filters contacts by meeting. It also includes Add Meeting, Delete Meeting, and Rename Meeting commands.
Clear Search	Clears search text and dropdown filters.
Names selection menu	After selecting at least one checkbox, use All or None to manage visible row selection.

Message Modal

- **Message text:** The text sent separately to each selected phone number.
- **Phone list:** Shows eligible selected phone numbers. Home, NH, and Work labels are skipped.
- **Send Separate Messages:** Sends or opens one message per selected phone number.

- **Close / Done:** Closes the modal after sending or cancels before sending.

Email Modal

- **Subject:** Subject line for the email.
- **Message:** Email body text.
- **Email address list:** Shows eligible email addresses for selected contacts.
- **Open Email:** Opens the default email app with selected addresses in BCC.

Contact Detail And Contact Editor

Contact Detail Page

The detail page shows a single contact's identity, assignments, phone numbers, email addresses, relationships, addresses, miscellaneous notes, and administration details.

Button / Link	What It Does
Back	Returns to the previous contacts list or filter state.
Edit	Opens the contact editor.
Restore	Appears for deleted/moved contacts and opens the editor in restore mode.
Phone links	Open phone or SMS links where supported by the computer/device.
Email links	Open the default mail app for that address.
Google Maps / Apple Maps	Open the selected address in the map service.
Move Contact to Deleted	Moves the contact to Deleted after confirmation.

Contact Editor Page

Section / Button	What It Does
Save	Saves the contact locally and queues Google/Drive sync if enabled.
Cancel / Back	Leaves the editor without saving the current form changes.
Identity	Edits family name, given name, photo, and identity details.
Assignments	Sets Fields and Meetings. Option modals can add new values.
Emails	Adds, edits, and removes email rows.
Phones	Adds, edits, and removes phone rows and labels.
Addresses	Adds, edits, and removes address rows.
Relationships	Records family or relationship details.
Custom Fields	Stores additional named values.
Notes	Stores miscellaneous notes about the contact.
Crop Contact Photo	Opens the crop modal after selecting a photo.

Move Contacts Page

The Move Contacts page changes the Fields and Meetings for selected contacts. It shows assignments on the left and selected contacts on the right, with Cancel and Apply-style controls.

MeetingData

MeetingData stores meeting-oriented sections and rows for printable meeting pages. The current visual editor is under `/meetings/v2/sections`.

MeetingData Sections Page

Control	What It Does
Section list rows	Open the visual editor for a Field + Meeting section.
Create section controls	Create a new MeetingData section from field and meeting choices.
Field/Meeting option modal	Add, remove, or rename available section option values.
NO-EDIT banner	Indicates editing is blocked until an Editor signs in when multi-editor mode is active.

MeetingData Editor Page

Control	What It Does
Back to sections	Returns to the MeetingData section list.
Save	Saves the visual MeetingData layout.
Meeting Print Preview	Opens a printable preview of the selected MeetingData section.
Edit Layout	Opens Address Book layout settings for the section's book layout.
Visual Canvas	Edits rows, columns, text cells, flow columns, full-width rows, and formatting on a book-page-width canvas.
Add/Delete row and column controls	Insert, remove, and reorganize MeetingData layout elements.
Delete All Rows modal	Confirms destructive removal of rows in the section.

Meeting Print Preview

Shows the meeting page as it will print. Use Back to Editor to return to layout editing.

Field List

The Field List page creates contact lists by field and meeting. It can print a field list using selected template and typography rules.

Control	What It Does
Create Field List	Starts a new field list template.
View Templates	Opens or prepares access to saved templates.
Template name	Names the current field list template.
Save Template	Saves the current field list template locally and queues Drive export if enabled.
Print	Generates a printable field list page.
Fields panel	Chooses which fields are included.
Meetings panel	Chooses which meetings are included.
Palette / blocks	Uses block types such as field name, meeting name, phone number, address, relationships, emails, and page number.
Font conflict modal	Resolves Bible font conflicts or typography mismatches before printing.

Address Book

The Address Book page builds PDF output for a printed or shared address book. It uses book layout settings, contact data, cover choices, index navigation, print order, and field selections.

Control	What It Does
Book layout selector/name	Chooses or names the active address book layout preset.
Save / Set Default	Saves layout changes or makes the selected layout the default.
Cover controls	Selects whether to include a cover, cover picture, cover title text, and cover date text.
Choose picture modal	Selects or changes the cover image used in the PDF.
Index controls	Controls whether index navigation is included.
Print Order	Opens a drag-and-drop modal to control placement/order of contacts or sections.
Print PDF	Opens field choices and generates the address book PDF.
Paper Book / Print Paper	Creates paper-book output using the current layout and field selections.
PDF Preview	Displays generated PDF output and provides a Back to Editor link.

Changes List

The Changes List records shared notes for Contacts and MeetingData changes. It is intended as a quick visible change log for editors.

Control	What It Does
Add row	Adds a new change entry.
Name/Event	Records the person, event, or subject of the change.
Changes text	Records the change note.
Automatic date/initials	Tracks when and by whom a change row was edited, when the current editor is known.
Done	Returns to GoogleConnect.

EditLists

EditLists show recent editing batches for Contacts and MeetingData.

Menu Item	What It Does
Contacts Edit List	Shows recent contact edit batches. Click a contact link to open the contact editor.
MeetingData Edit List	Shows recent MeetingData edit batches. Click a section link to open the MeetingData editor.

GoogleConnect

GoogleConnect controls account connection, editor sign-in, role access, imports, uploads, and sync state. It is the operational center for shared editing.

Connection Controls

Control	What It Does
Sign In With Google	Starts Google OAuth sign-in.
Reconnect / Switch Account	Reconnects Drive/Contacts scopes or switches the connected Google account.
Disconnect	Removes the local Google account connection.
Remember preferred account	Stores the preferred Google email for future sign-in workflows.

Editor And Access Roles

Control	What It Does
Editor name	Identifies the current editor for locks and changes.
Editor secret	Password-style field required for Editor access when enabled.
Sign in as Editor	Attempts to acquire the Editor lock.
Sign out	Releases the editor/access role and may trigger required sync checks.
Take over stale lock	Allows takeover when a previous editor lock is stale.
Access role sign-in	Signs in with special roles such as Field List or Address Book where configured.
Add 15 minutes	Extends the active Editor session when the timeout warning appears.

Sync And Upload Controls

Control	What It Does
Upload	Processes pending contact changes and shared app data to Google/Drive.
Upload status	Shows pending count, active upload state, current contact, errors, and Drive bootstrap progress.
Retry Drive sync	Retries shared sign-in sync if it stopped or failed.

Import	Opens the import confirmation screen for Google Contacts or Drive backup import.
App Revisions setup/export	Creates Drive storage for App Revisions and exports the local revision list.

Settings Pages

ContactsFreeShare Settings

Control	What It Does
Will this app be used by multiple Editors?	Turns multi-editor mode on or off. Multi-editor mode requires editor sign-in and one active editor at a time.
Single-Editor save location	Chooses local-only saving or Google/Drive syncing when multi-editor mode is off.
Editor secret	Changes the Editor secret. Leaving it blank keeps the current secret.
Editor lock-out time	Sets the Editor session timeout.
Shared Address Book PDF copy	Controls whether generated Address Book PDFs are also copied to a shared Drive folder.
Shared folder ID / fallback folder name	Identifies the shared Drive folder used for Address Book PDF copies.
Contacts Colors	Sets contact title, primary row, secondary row, and hover colors.
MeetingData Colors	Sets MeetingData title, primary row, secondary row, and hover colors.
Save Settings	Saves settings locally and queues Drive export when sync is enabled.

Address Book / Field List Settings

Control	What It Does
Margins	Sets page margins for printed layouts.
Typography	Controls font family, base font size, and line height.
Preview scale	Sets how large the layout preview appears on screen.
Column and address settings	Controls field list/address book column behavior and address alignment.
Save Settings	Saves the address book/field list settings.

Contacts Settings And MeetingData Settings

These settings pages control color and layout presets for the Contacts and MeetingData sections. Save Settings applies the current choices.

App Revisions And Updates

The App Revisions page shows recent release notes and the public update status.

Control	What It Does
App Update panel	Shows installed version, latest version, release notes, and whether an update is available.
Download Mac / Download Windows	Appears when an update is available and downloads the selected update package.
Revision table	Shows recent app revision dates, versions, and descriptions.
Hidden developer editor	When activated by the developer shortcut, allows editing App Revisions and syncing them to Drive.
Check for updates	Available from the ContactsFreeShare menu; reads the public update manifest.

Import, Export, Backup, And Restore

Import Confirmation Page

The import page displays warnings before replacing or importing contact data. Importing from Google Contacts or Drive backup should be treated carefully because it can change local data.

Control	What It Does
Cancel	Returns to the previous page without importing.
Import from Google Contacts	Imports contacts from the connected Google account after confirmation.
Import from backup in Google Drive	Imports contacts from a selected Drive backup after confirmation.

Export And Backup Outputs

- **App CSV:** A ContactsFreeShare-specific contacts CSV.
- **Google CSV:** A contacts CSV intended for Google import compatibility.
- **vCard:** A standard contact file format.
- **JSON backups:** Full app backup files for Contacts or MeetingData.

Editing Roles, Sync, And Safety Notes

- **Local saving:** The app always keeps local data on the current computer.
- **Google Contacts:** Contact changes can be queued and uploaded to Google Contacts when Google saving is enabled.
- **Google Drive:** Shared settings, MeetingData, Field List data, App Revisions, backups, and PDFs can use Drive storage.
- **NO-EDIT mode:** In multi-editor mode, users cannot edit until an Editor signs in or a permitted access role is active.
- **Editor lock:** Prevents multiple active editors from editing at the same time.
- **Pending uploads:** Banners and Upload reminders show when local changes need to be sent to Google/Drive.
- **Messaging:** macOS Messages automation can submit messages to Messages, but carrier/iMessage delivery is ultimately controlled by the paired phone and Apple services.

Publishing App Updates

Developer update publishing is handled by scripts in the project folder.

Command	What It Does
<code>bash scripts/build_portable_app.sh</code>	Builds the portable app folder and Mac/Windows zip files in <code>dist/</code> . It also creates <code>app_update_manifest.example.json</code> .
<code>scripts/publish_app_update.sh 1.2 "Release notes"</code>	Updates <code>APP_VERSION</code> , adds an App Revisions row, builds packages, creates <code>app_update_manifest.json</code> , removes older update zips by default, and pushes the current packages to the GitHub Pages update repo.
<code>CONTACTSFREESHARE_KEEP_OLD_UPDATE_PACKAGES=1</code> <code>...</code>	Optional prefix that keeps older package zips instead of cleaning them.

Use straight quotes in Terminal around release notes. This matters when release notes contain characters such as `&`.